

f00tils

Freestanding assembly GNU userland * <https://f00.sh>

Reply to Attn of: REL/F00

TO: Maintainers and Users

FROM: Project Engineering

SUBJECT: Release memo - f00tils 0.16.6

REF: CHANGELOG.md, v0.16.5 A/B/C surface, CI quality gates

Bottom line: Ship 0.16.6 as a patch over 0.16.5. Primary change is locale-exact C/POSIX classification for cmp and diff -c so GitHub Actions (C.UTF-8) matches GNU. 0.16.5 product surface (A/B/C gates, modern power, split win) remains; release CI for v0.16.5 failed quality gates and is superseded by this tag.

1. Purpose

Record what 0.16.6 ships, why the retag policy chose a new patch, and how operators verify.

2. Why 0.16.6 (not force-retag 0.16.5)

House SemVer rules forbid retagging a published version with different artifacts. v0.16.5 was pushed; Release workflow quality gates failed on cmp char/byte and diff -c timestamp format under C.UTF-8. The fix is a behavioral correction; ship as 0.16.6.

3. Changes in this release

- locale_is_c / cmp differ wording: exact C or POSIX only (not C.UTF-8 prefix match)
- diff -c headers: ctime only under exact C/POSIX; ISO+tz under C.UTF-8 and other locales
- Operator SOP + this release memo tracked under docs/ and linked from README
- Carries full 0.16.5 A/B/C work: make abc, modern grep/find/diff/cat power, split bulk suffixes, suite split WIN

4. Verification

4.1 cd asm && make && make check

4.2 Under LC_ALL=C.UTF-8: cmp differ says byte; under LC_ALL=C: char

4.3 Under LC_ALL=C.UTF-8: diff -c headers are ISO; under LC_ALL=C: ctime

4.4 GitHub Release workflow green for tag v0.16.6; Pages deploys site/

5. Install

`curl -fsSL https://f00.sh/install.sh | bash (pin with F00_VERSION=v0.16.6).`

Project Engineering
f00tils release

Date: 2026-07-27

cc: ['https://f00.sh * github.com/theesfeld/f00']